Wednesday, 13 May 2026

Conference Announcement



Mini-Conference: "Distant Past(s) – Current Future(s):
Digitization, Digital Objects and Datafication Approaches in Ancient and Medieval Studies"

Pre-Conference Event at DH2026 "Engagement" (27–31 July 2026 | dh2026.adho.org) in Daejeon, South Korea

Organizers: Marina Sartori & Victoria G. D. Landau
Date & Time: Tuesday, 28 July 2026 – 09:00-17:30 UTC+9
Venue: Daejeon Convention Center & Zoom (hybrid)

Bringing together scholars of ancient civilizations and medieval studies, museum professionals, librarians and curators, collection custodians and caretakers, educators as well as technical experts well-versed in bridging evidence of the past and digital approaches, this conference intends to offer a forum of exchange, best practices, ideas and possible avenues centered around ancient and medieval topics, objects and materials.

This event offers a platform for scholars venturing into DH practices, methodologies and tools, those with experience bridging evidence of the past and technical approaches, and technical experts contributing to projects centering ancient and medieval topics, objects and materials. Open discussions will feature questions regarding the talks, as well as touching more broadly on the topics of ethics, accessibility (open vs. closed), reuse of data, modelling, mapping, object and data ownership, imaging (e.g., IIIF), methods of increasing engagement, curation and sustainability.

The conference committee further welcomes participation by scholars and practitioners at all career stages concentrating on areas not always included in the traditional "Classics" descriptor, such as archaeology of the Americas, Asia, Africa and Oceania, historical ethnology and anthropology, digital historical linguistics and more. Participants from interdisciplinary areas such as game and media studies, (meta)data science and (open access) publishing are also welcome.

As a pre-conference event at the annual international *Alliance of Digital Humanities Organizations* (ADHO) conference, taking place as *DH2026* (27.–31.07.2026) in Daejeon, South Korea, this conference will have a hybrid format, with both on-site and online contributions. All talks will be recorded and made available after the conference. Virtual participation is open both to persons attending DH2026 and those who are not. In-person participants are required to register for DH2026 via dh2026.adho.org (Early Bird registration ends on Mon. 18.05.2026).

Participant Registration Deadline: 01.07.2026, 23:59 UTC+1

For more information, and to register as a participant, please visit the mini-conference website here:

vlandau.notion.site/distant-pasts-current-futures-2026

Wednesday, 13 May 2026

Mini-Conference Program

Morning (09:00–12:30 KST)

08:30 Morning Coffee & Tech Prep

09:00 Welcome

09:15 **Young Un Kang, Jaehwan Kim, Juchan Son (Seoul)** «Toward an Ontology-Enriched Open Corpus of New Testament Greek»

09:35 **Natasha Hodgson (Nottingham)** «Legacy Digital and Digital Legacies: The Database of Crusaders to the Holy Land»

09:55 **Ruoci Song (Cambridge)** «Ancient Authority as Interpretive Infrastructure: Source-Aware Access in a Dante Commentary Workbench»

10:15 Open Discussion

10:30 **Elizabeth Zanghi (Columbia, MO)** «Probable Pasts: Bayesian Inference for the Holistic Study of Byzantine Cappadocia»

10:40 **Isra Saymour (Toronto)** «The Carnival and the Fortress: Old Modalities of Access, Ownership, and Control in New Digital Worlds»

10:50 **Mahnoush Pourhosseini Akbarie (Rome), Barbara McGillivray (London)** «Bias-Aware Adaptive Rewriting of Medieval Museum Texts: A Knowledge-Guided Approach to Inclusive Cultural Heritage Interpretation»

11:00 Open Discussion

11:15 Break

11:30 **Sabrina Strutz, Martina Scholger, Elisabeth Steiner, Melanie Frauendorfer (Graz)** «At the Margins of the "Medieval": A 17th-Century Colonial Dictionary as Digital Scholarly Edition»

11:50 **Melissa Williams (Boston)** «Against and Within the Canon: Mapping the Intertextual Strategies of Ignatius Sancho through Computational Text Analysis»

12:15 Open Discussion

— 12:30–13:45 Lunch —

Afternoon (14:00–17:30 KST)

14:00 **Joel Sams (Liverpool)** «Reconstructing the Book of the Dead of Ramose»

14:20 **Hana Navratilova (Oxford)** «Graffiti Gazetteer: Research Infrastructure for Secondary Epigraphy»

14:45 Open Discussion

15:00 **Jaume Noguera (Barcelona)** «Sequential Maps of Ancient Conflicts»

15:10 **Ezéchiel Sawadogo, Mamadou Diouhé Barry, Saranga K. Mahanta, Victoria Eyharabide (Paris)** «Digital Curation and Datafication of Byzantine Seal Monograms: From Annotation to Classification»

15:20 **Aaron Macks (Cambridge, MA)** «Tying the Strands Together: Books of Hours and Proteins»

15:30 Open Discussion

15:45 Break

16:00 **Anastasia Poliakova (Hamburg), Giovanni Ciotti (Bologna)** «Turning Rubbish into Knowledge: Fallen-Off Fragments Help Reconstruct the Provenance and Material History of Palm-Leaf Manuscripts»

16:20 **Jongwook Lee (Buyeo)** «Korean Cases of Heritage Archiving and Agent Construction: From the Perspective of Digital Twins and an Integrated Knowledge Base»

16:45 Open Discussion

17:15 Summary and Outlook